

tribute

Musical Treasure

MUMBAI "I want to play the flute till I turn 100 and make people happy by my music. I don't want to look back at my struggles and draw parables out of it." These words by flute maestro Pandit Hari Prasad Chaurasia portray his zeal for the future as he celebrates his 70th birthday on July 1. All the same, there is no taking away from the fact that the celebrations, being organised by students of his Vrindavan Gurukul, are a fitting testimony to a tradition that has withstood the vagaries of time.

"I am a great believer of the *guru-shishya parampara*," admits Chaurasia, adding that he was fortunate enough to have a guru like Annapurna Deviji. "Whenever I visit a temple, I pray to God to be reborn as a musician and have her as my guru," he says.

The evening of his birthday will witness Hari

Rang Hari Sang, a musical programme with live performances by a group of talented musicians from Pune and Mumbai, including some surprise guest artistes. A few audio-visual presentations and a full-fledged concert by the students of the gurukul have also been lined up for the day.

The programme will begin with the versatile Sonu Nigam interviewing the maestro. The event also marks the release of an official biography of Chaurasia titled *Woodwinds of Change* by Surjit Singh. To be launched by

Bollywood star Amitabh Bachchan, the book presents a rare insight into Chaurasia's life and his contribution to music. Music Today will also be releasing an album *Hari Rang*, which unfolds his musical treasure, covering the live concert of his two extremely popular evening ragas—Yaman and Hansadhvani. Be there to enjoy this musical treat. At Nehru Centre.

by S. Sahaya Ranjit



HARI RANG

MUSIC TODAY, Rs 299

BLISSFUL BAMBOO: Pandit Hari Prasad Chaurasia



art exhibition

Brushing with Expression

KOLKATA Art lovers will soon be able to experience an expression of art from across the border as 10 well-known women artists from Bangladesh showcase their paintings in the city. Titled *Faces of Feminine Expressions* from Bangladesh, the exhibition will be a common platform to represent some of the most divergent trends in contemporary art of the country. The paintings focus on various social and feminist issues prevailing in Bangladesh. Each artist portrays her own distinctive way of reaching out to the viewer, giving expression to her own understanding of the socio-political and gender issues. Even nature is used as a metaphor for these issues in some of the paintings. In most of the canvases, a woman is depicted alone, which may be a portrayal of the sense of loneliness or alienation in a male-dominated society. The artists whose works are on display include Nazlee Laila Mansur, Nasreen Begum, Rokeya Sultana, Dilara Begum Jolly and Tayeba Begum Lipi. From June 20. At Aakar Prakar Gallery.

by Elora Sen

DIFFERENT STROKES: A painting by Lipi on display



festival

Mystic Melody

DELHI The Swar Rang festival of dance and music is the one where you can enjoy the traditions of both north and south India.

While vocalist Savita Devi, daughter of the legendary Siddheswari Devi, will present semi-classical forms like thumri and kajri, Deepti Omchery will present Mohiniattam.



Savita Devi

There are only a few singers left now who can carry on the tradition of thumri singing and Savita Devi is one of them. Don't miss. At India Habitat Centre. On June 24.